the past 30 years), and also on its periphery. The risk of collision with a bottlenose dolphin is also a threat identified by the Pelagos sanctuary for Mediterranean marine mammals.

2 Vessel Traffic characteristics

2.1 In 2009, Bonifacio Trafic (the Franco-Italian service) received 2,984 mandatory ship reports. Among them were 180 abnormalities (breaches of IMO Assembly resolution A.766(18)) of which 108 were for transport of dangerous goods, amounting to 147,013 tonnes (141,867 tonnes in 2008). The offences included 55 cases of sending a mandatory report after entering the system, 19 relating to ships found to be following a route that was not recommended (down by 33% on 2008) and 108 relating to ships carrying dangerous

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SOURCE: MEPC.204(62).pdf
after entering the system, 19 relating to ships found to be following a route that was not recommended (down by 33% on 2008) and 108 relating to ships carrying dangerous goods (+9%).

* The text in this annex is taken from the submission by France and Italy contained in documents MEPC 61/9 and MEPC 61/INF.26.
RESOLUTION MEPC.204(62)
Adopted on 15 July 2011
DESIGNATION OF THE STRAIT OF BONIFACIO
AS A PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 62/24/Add.1
Annex 22, page 14

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2.2 In 2009 a total of 157 ships carrying dangerous goods passed through the Strait of Bonifacio:

- 70 container ships;
- 61 ro-ro ships;
- 13 bulk carriers;
- five chemical carriers;
- three oil tankers;
- three gas tankers;
- two ferries.

2.3 The 2,984 vessels which navigated in the Strait of Bonifacio in 2009 were distributed as follows:

European Union

Italy 831; France 371; Malta 251; Netherlands 152; Portugal 78; United Kingdom 67; Cyprus 50.

Non-EU

Turkey 100; Antigua 183; Bahamas 165; Panama 143.

2.4 The status that the Strait of Bonifacio enjoys as an international strait and the

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SOURCE: MEPC.204(62).pdf
Italy 831; France 371; Malta 251; Netherlands 152; Portugal 78; United Kingdom 67; Cyprus 50.

Non-EU

Turkey 100; Antigua 183; Bahamas 165; Panama 143.

2.4 The status that the Strait of Bonifacio enjoys as an international strait and the provisions of IMO resolution A.766(18) contribute to making it, although it is apart from the major shipping routes (3,000 ships per year) and its dangerousness is well known, an area in which the coastal authorities are confined to the role of spectator, waiting for a maritime accident to happen.

RESOLUTION MEPC.204(62)
Adopted on 15 July 2011
DESIGNATION OF THE STRAIT OF BONIFACIO
AS A PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 62/24/Add.1
Annex 22, page 15

I:\MEPC\62\24-Add-1.doc
ANNEX 4

ASSOCIATED PROTECTIVE MEASURE FOR THE STRAIT OF BONIFACIO PSSA

Description of the Area

The Strait of Bonifacio separates the Italian island of Sardinia from the French island of Corsica; they are only 11 km apart. The Strait takes its name from Bonifacio, the southernmost town of Corsica. It enables passage from the Sea of Sardinia in the west to

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SOURCE: MEPC.204(62).pdf
Corsica; they are only 11 km apart. The Strait takes its name from Bonifacio, the southernmost town of Corsica. It enables passage from the Sea of Sardinia in the west to the Tyrrhenian Sea in the east. Its width varies from eight to ten nautical miles and its maximum depth is 100 m.

At the eastern end lies the Italian archipelago of La Maddalena, and Cavallo island and the Lavezzi Islands, belonging to France. This is a s ensitive area for navigation. In the northern part of the Strait, ships have to avoid the reefs of Perduto and the Lavezzi Islands, while in the south lie the Sardinian islands of Razzoli and Persa. Navigation is possible along a narrow three-mile wide stretch and ships are asked to take a recommended route wide just over one mile.

Recommendation on navigation through the Strait of Bonifacio*

1 Use of ships' routeing

Vessels navigating in the Strait shall exercise full diligence and regard for the requirements of the existing recommended two-way route in the Strait of Bonifacio. Due to the narrowness of the Strait, masters of vessels shall ensure that an appropriate monitoring of the ship's

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SOURCE: MEPC.204(62).pdf
of the existing recommended two-way route in the Strait of Bonifacio. Due to the narrowness of the Strait, masters of vessels shall ensure that an appropriate monitoring of the ship's route is done on board in order to avoid groundings and collisions.

2 Ship reporting and navigation information

Ships of 300 GT and over entering the Strait shall participate in the mandatory ship reporting system (BONIFREP) established by the co mpetent authorities as described in IMO's publication on Ships' Routeing (Section G I/8).

3 Pilotage

Masters of vessels passing through the Strait are recommended to avail themselves of the services of a qualified pilot.

3.1 Categories of ships concerned

Ships for which the IMO Assembly recommends in its resolution A.766(18) of 17 November 1993 to Governments to prohibit or at least strongly discourage the transit in the Strait of Bonifacio: laden oil tankers and ships carrying dangerous chemicals or substances in bulk, as listed in the annex to resolution MEPC.49(31) adopted on 4 July 1991.

* The text on this APM is directly ta ken from document NAV 57/15, annex 2.

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SOURCE: MEPC.204(62).pdf
substances in bulk, as listed in the annex to resolution MEPC.49(31) adopted on 4 July 1991.

* The text on this APM is directly ta ken from document NAV 57/15, annex 2.

3.2 Description of the applicable procedure for requesting a pilot

Vessels wishing to order a Bonifacio Strait pilot should, as much as possible, send by e-mail or by fax the following information to the service named "Bonifacio Strait pilotage":

- ship's name and call sign;
- type of vessel and gross tonnage;

- draught;
- destination port/name and address of the local agent;
- boarding position and ETA.

24 hours prior to arrival, vessels should inform or confirm their ETA to the head office of the Bonifacio Strait pilotage service.

Once on Bonifacio Strait road, vessels should confirm their ETA 2 hours prior to arrival calling "Bonifacio Traffic" on VHF 10.

3.3 Description of the pilotage service

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SOURCE: MEPC.204(62).pdf
Bonifacio Strait pilotage service.

Once on Bonifacio Strait road, vessels should confirm their ETA 2 hours prior to arrival calling "Bonifacio Traffic" on VHF 10.

3.3 Description of the pilotage service

The pilotage area covers the Strait and its approaches. Usually the vessels entering the